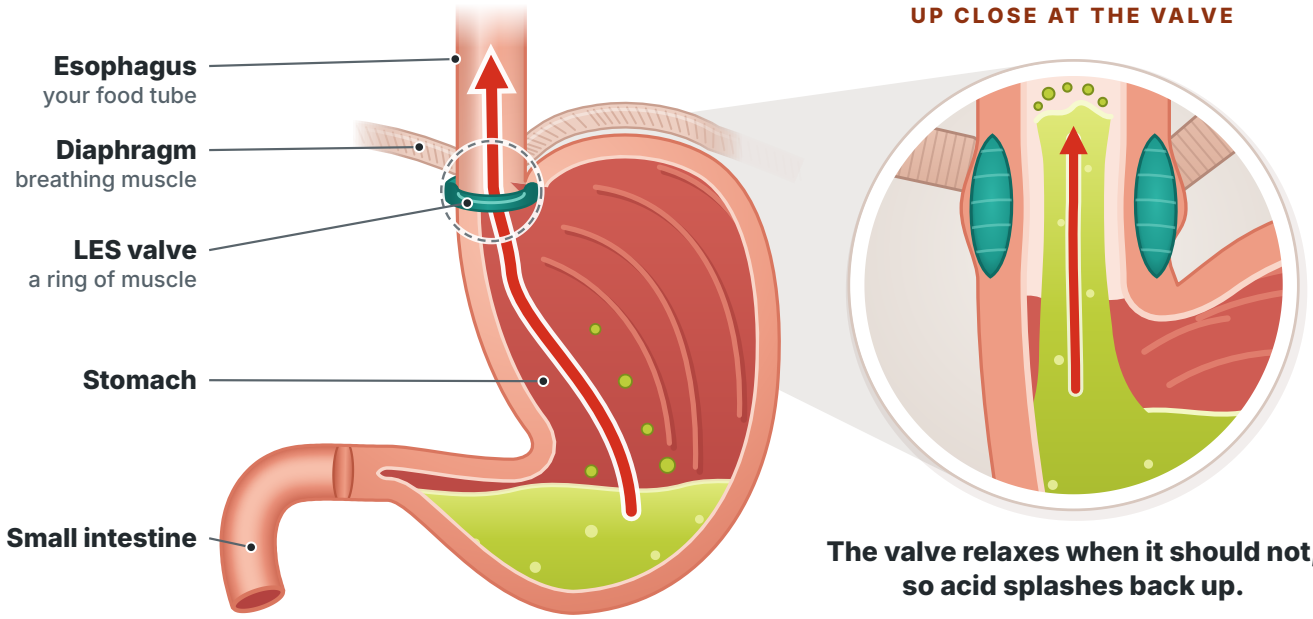
Patient name _____ Date _____

Acid Reflux and GERD

Gastroesophageal reflux disease

Reflux now and then is normal. When it happens often or harms the food tube, it is called **GERD**, and about **1 in 5 U.S. adults** has it. A ring of muscle, the **LES valve** (lower esophageal sphincter), sits where the food tube (the **esophagus**) meets the stomach. It opens to let food in, then shuts tight. In GERD it opens when it should not, or does not close well, so acid splashes up. The stomach has a coat that shields it from acid; the esophagus does not, so it burns (**heartburn**).



KEY — Stomach acid: pool and drops · LES valve: halved up close · Diaphragm: hugs the valve · Reflux: acid moving up · Food tube lining · Stomach lining · Dashed circle: zoomed in

HOW IT CAN FEEL

- Burning behind the breastbone
- A sour taste, or food coming up
- Hoarse voice, throat clearing
- A dry cough that hangs on
- Upset stomach after meals
- Bad breath, worn tooth enamel

Why treat it? Left alone, acid can inflame, narrow or scar the esophagus, and in a few people it changes the lining (Barrett's esophagus), which needs checkups.

GET CARE RIGHT AWAY IF

- Food sticks, or it hurts to swallow
- You throw up blood or coffee-ground bits
- Your stools are black or tarry
- **Chest pain: call 911.** It can be the heart.

See a doctor soon if you lose weight without trying.

COMMON TRIGGERS

They differ from person to person. Notice which ones bother you.

Fried or fatty food · Spicy food · Chocolate · Peppermint · Coffee · Alcohol · Citrus and tomato · Fizzy drinks · Big or late meals · Smoking

ABOUT ACID-BLOCKING MEDICINES

PPIs (like omeprazole) and H2 blockers (like famotidine) help many people heal. But acid also helps you absorb nutrients. The FDA has warned about low magnesium with long-term PPI use, and about broken bones, mostly at high doses or after a year or more.[1] **Taken one for months? Do not stop suddenly:** ask your pharmacist or your prescriber for a plan.

LONG-TERM PPIs CAN LOWER ABSORPTION OF

Mg Magnesium · Ca Calcium · B12 Vitamin B12 · Fe Iron · Zn Zinc

Ask your pharmacist if a nutrient check makes sense.

1. U.S. FDA Drug Safety Communications on proton pump inhibitors (PPIs): possible fracture risk (2010); low magnesium with long-term use (2011).

Lifestyle Modifications

Early dinner
Finish eating 3 hours before you lie down.

Raise the head
Blocks or a wedge, 6 to 8 inches. Not pillows.

Smaller meals
Eat slowly, with plenty of plants.

Stay upright
No bending or hard exercise after meals.

A healthy weight
Lose extra weight: less pressure on the valve.

Stop smoking
Smoking loosens the valve.

Nutrient Solutions

What your body needs, and the NutriDyn formula that delivers it

START HERE

Strengthen the lining
zinc carnosine



Zinc-Carnosine
60 capsules · 60 servings

- Supports the lining of your stomach and food tube ◆
- Try it on its own for the first week

IN EACH SERVING
17 mg zinc + 58 mg L-carnosine (75 mg zinc carnosine, as PepZin GI)

1 capsule daily
at bedtime, empty stomach

Mucus layer support
chewable DGL licorice



Licorice DGL Pro
90 tablets · 30 servings

- Supports the stomach's soothing mucus layer ◆
- Most of the licorice part that can raise blood pressure is removed

IN EACH SERVING
Per 3 tablets: 75 mg DGL extract, 100 mg glycine, 100 mg L-glutamine, 30 mg NAC, 5 mg zinc

Chew 3 tablets
after dinner

Lining blend
zinc carnosine, aloe, DGL



GI Integrity
Peach Tea, Berry, Chocolate

- Supports the lining from food tube to gut ◆
- Sip it slowly in 6 to 8 oz water; skip it if pregnant or nursing

IN EACH SERVING
3 g L-glutamine, 1 g glucosamine HCl, 400 mg DGL, 300 mg aloe, 200 mg slippery elm, 16 mg zinc

1 scoop daily
in place of Zinc-Carnosine

Balance the gut
spore probiotic



UltraBiotic Spore Probio
60 capsules · 30 servings

- Supports a healthy, balanced gut ◆
- Adds XOS, a prebiotic fiber

IN EACH SERVING
Per 2 capsules: a 4-strain spore probiotic blend (5 billion CFU), 300 mg XOS, 100 mg enzymes

2 capsules daily
with breakfast

Cover the basics
daily multivitamin



Essential Multi with Iron
90 capsules · 30 servings

- Supports daily vitamin and mineral needs ◆
- Skip it if pregnant or nursing

IN EACH SERVING
Per 3 capsules: 18 mg iron, 15 mg zinc, 200 mcg B12, 1,360 mcg DFE folate, 120 mcg vitamin K

3 capsules daily
with breakfast

YOUR DAILY RHYTHM

Morning	Evening meal	Bedtime
UltraBiotic Spore Probio 2 capsules Essential Multi with Iron 3 capsules	Licorice DGL Pro 3 tablets	Zinc-Carnosine 1 capsule

The full plan is **9 pills a day**. Some doses are lower than the bottle says **on purpose**, to limit zinc: follow this plan unless your pharmacist changes it. Start with the **Start here** pick, then add one a week. Your pharmacist may swap the Zinc-Carnosine capsule for 1 scoop of GI Integrity between meals, never both.

PHARMACIST CHECK

Keep taking your medicines.

- **Zinc adds up.** The plan gives about 37 mg of zinc a day. With the zinc in food (about 10 mg), that is above the 40 mg adult upper limit, so use it only as long as your pharmacist advises: long use can lower copper. Take no other zinc or multi unless your prescriber says so. Doses are for adults.
- **Iron check.** The multi has 18 mg of iron. Men and women past menopause usually need no extra iron unless a test shows it: ask your pharmacist.
- **Space the minerals.** Take antibiotics like cipro or doxycycline 2 hours before or 6 hours after the zinc and iron here, and thyroid pills 4 hours apart.
- **On a blood thinner?** The multi's vitamin K and GI Integrity's glucosamine can change how warfarin works: ask your pharmacist and whoever manages it first.
- **Stomach acid check.** Many people with reflux may actually run low on stomach acid. Your practitioner may check it with an HCl challenge (an acid-pill test). Never test yourself, and never take stomach-acid pills (betaine hydrochloride) on your own, with an ulcer or gastritis, or with NSAIDs (like ibuprofen).

Special considerations for you:

Recommended by _____ Phone _____

◆ These statements have not been evaluated by the Food and Drug Administration. These products are not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any disease.